
My Floristry *Learning* Workbook

A self-guided study companion for UK floristry students.

LEARN · CREATE · GROW

My Floristry Helper

A STUDY COMPANION

No. 01

Welcome to your *floristry* workbook.

This workbook is yours. It's a quiet place to gather what you learn — flowers you've handled, palettes you love, techniques you're chasing, and the small habits that shape a craftsperson over time.

Work through it slowly. Some pages are exercises; some are open canvases. Treat the prompts as starting points, not assignments. Write, sketch, paste pressed leaves, smear a little stem-sap — make it feel lived-in.

There are six weekly study spreads to pace your first cycle, a confidence tracker to help you notice progress, and reference pages you'll return to. Beyond that, you decide the order.

HOW TO USE

1. Begin with the *Profile* page — your starting point.
2. Sketch the *Roadmap* stages you'll work through.
3. Use one weekly spread per week. Fridays are for reflection.
4. Fill an Observation Log entry for every new flower.
5. Return to the Confidence Tracker monthly.
6. Keep the Glossary growing — add your own terms.

SECTION ONE

Foundations

Profile, roadmap, your first six weeks of practice.

SECTION TWO

Practice

Logs, bouquets, conditioning, colour studies.

SECTION THREE

Reference

Skills tracker, RHS routes, resources, glossary.

My Floristry Profile

Begin by sketching where you stand today. Honest answers make better study — there are no wrong notes here.

NAME

A FLORIST I ADMIRE

DATE STARTED

MY PREFERRED STYLE

WHERE I STUDY / WORK

SEASON I LOVE MOST

YEARS IN FLORISTRY

A SKILL I'M CHASING

MY FAVOURITE FLOWER, TODAY

A HABIT TO BUILD

A FLOWER I WANT TO LEARN

SOMETHING I AVOID — FOR NOW

MY GOAL FOR THIS WORKBOOK · A FREEWRITE

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The Learning Roadmap

A scaffold, not a schedule. Move at your own pace — return to earlier stages whenever your hands need them.

STAGE ONE

01

Foundations

- ☐ Identify 30 common cut flowers
- ☐ Basic conditioning routine
- ☐ Understand vase-life basics
- ☐ Wrap & present a posy
- ☐ Hold & care for your tools
- ☐ Cut, strip, and clean stems
- ☐ Spiral a simple hand-tied
- ☐ Keep a tidy work bench

STAGE TWO

02

Craft

- ☐ Work a structured hand-tied
- ☐ Free-style in a vessel
- ☐ Compose a bridal bouquet
- ☐ Apply colour harmonies
- ☐ Build an arrangement in foam
- ☐ Wire a buttonhole / corsage
- ☐ Funeral tribute basics
- ☐ Cost a piece end-to-end

STAGE THREE

03

Studio

- ☐ Design a seasonal collection
- ☐ Lead a wedding consultation
- ☐ Photograph your work well
- ☐ Mentor a beginner
- ☐ Source from a UK grower
- ☐ Install a large-scale piece
- ☐ Build a press / portfolio
- ☐ Set sustainability standards

Week 1 · Foundations

Tools, names, and the rhythm of the bench.

Mon

Walk the studio. Name every flower and foliage in stock — write the ones you don't know.

Tue

Practice three cuts: clean, angled, hollow stem. Note which flowers like which.

Wed

Identify five foliages by touch alone. What does each feel and smell like?

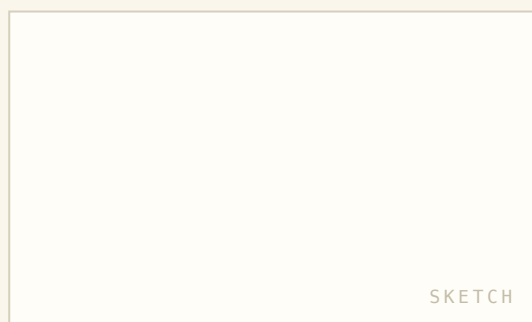
Thu

Spend an hour on tool care. Sharpen, clean, oil. List what you used.

FRIDAY *Reflection & making.*

CONFIDENCE ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

Spiral six stems of mixed material into a small posy. Photograph. Reflect below.



SKETCH

Week 2 · Conditioning

The quiet work that buys you days.

Mon

Condition a fresh delivery from start to finish. Time yourself.

Tue

Compare hot-water vs. cold-water conditioning on two woody stems.

Wed

Try sealing milky stems (euphorbia, poppy). Record vase-life over the week.

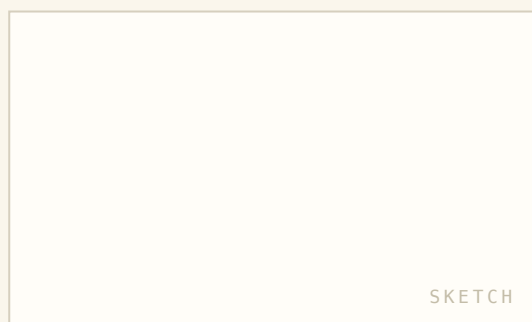
Thu

Strip, score, and condition hydrangea. Compare untreated vs. treated heads.

FRIDAY *Reflection & making.*

CONFIDENCE ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

Audit your conditioning notes from this week. Which flowers held best?



SKETCH

Week 3 · Hand-tieds

Spiral, balance, and the working hand.

Mon

Build a 12-stem spiral with one flower type. Focus on the binding point.

Tue

Repeat — now with three flower types. Photograph from above.

Wed

Aim for a domed silhouette. Tighter spiral, lower binding point.

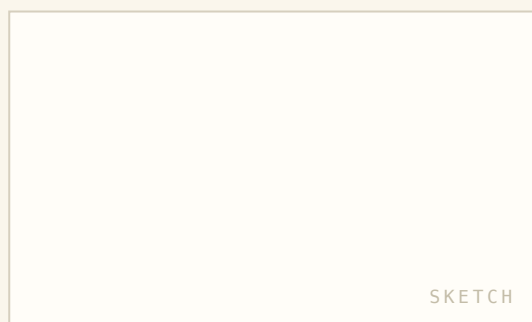
Thu

Trial an asymmetrical front-facing bouquet. Where does the eye land?

FRIDAY *Reflection & making.*

CONFIDENCE ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

Hand-tie a finished gift bouquet. Wrap, present, and price it.



SKETCH

Week 4 · Colour Theory

Hue, tone, and the harmonies of the season.

Mon

Build a monochrome palette in one colour. Five flowers, five tones.

Tue

Try a complementary palette. Why does it feel louder than analogous?

Wed

Make a tonal gradient from deepest to lightest. Photograph in daylight.

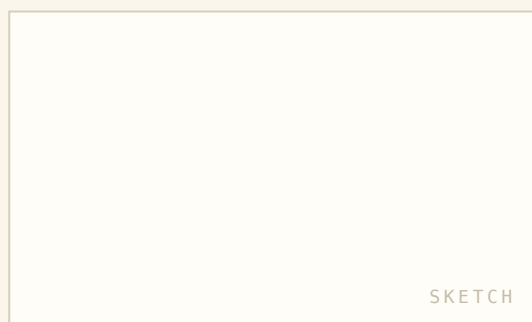
Thu

Limit yourself to one accent flower. Build the rest around it.

FRIDAY *Reflection & making.*

CONFIDENCE ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

Pick a season — match a palette to it. Justify each choice in writing.



SKETCH

Week 5 · Wedding Work

Story-led design for one of life's big days.

Mon

Choose a couple (real or imagined). Sketch a moodboard for their day.

Tue

Design a bridal bouquet. Define focal, secondary, filler, foliage.

Wed

Build buttonholes. Practice wire technique and finishing tape.

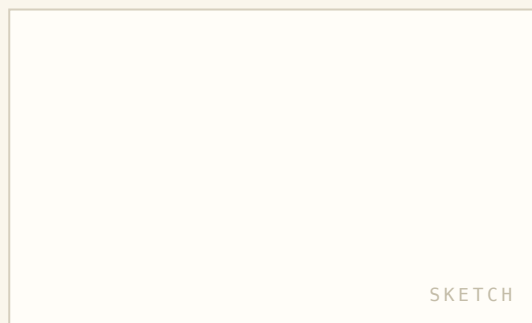
Thu

Plan a top-table arrangement. Vessel, mechanics, focal points.

FRIDAY *Reflection & making.*

CONFIDENCE ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

Mock the full set on the bench. Photograph as a flat-lay collection.



SKETCH

Week 6 · Sympathy & Funeral

Considered, gentle, and quietly skilled.

Mon

Read three pieces on funeral floristry traditions in the UK. Note customs.

Tue

Build a small posy in a softer, calmer palette. Restrained, not sombre.

Wed

Construct a sympathy sheaf. Practice the back-stem profile.

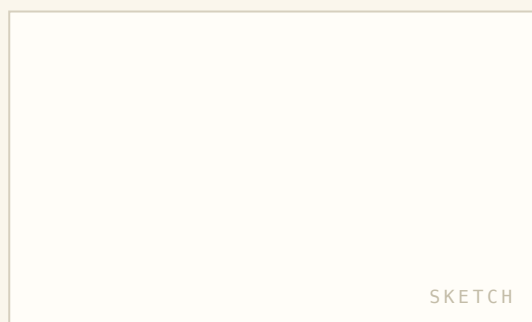
Thu

Study a casket spray photograph. Sketch the proportions onto the box below.

FRIDAY *Reflection & making.*

CONFIDENCE ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

Reflect on what makes funeral work feel right — to you and to a family.



SKETCH

Floral Observation Log

For every new flower that crosses your bench. Look slowly — the work is in the seeing.

Bouquet Planning Sheet

OCCASION

DATE

BUDGET (£)

RECIPIENT

STYLE

COLOUR PALETTE



RECIPE

FOCAL

FOCAL

FILLER

FILLER

FOLIAGE

FOLIAGE

ACCENT

VESSEL / WRAP

STEM COUNT

SKETCH

SKETCH

NOTES

Conditioning & Care Notes

Build a personal reference, flower by flower. Your notes will outlast any chart.

[illegible]

Mix tones until something stirs. Then name it, and ask why.

PALETTE I

No. ____



NAME

FLOWERS

HARMONY

BEST USE

PALETTE II

No. ____



NAME

FLOWERS

HARMONY

BEST USE

PALETTE III

No. ____



NAME

FLOWERS

HARMONY

BEST USE

PALETTE IV

No. ____



NAME

FLOWERS

HARMONY

BEST USE

Skill Confidence Tracker

TWENTY SKILLS · FIVE LEVELS

Fill a circle for each level of confidence — from tentative to teaching others. Revisit monthly.

☐ Just starting ☐ Building ☐ Confident ☐ Fluent ☐ Teaching others

SKILL	CONFIDENCE
01 Identifying common cut flowers	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
02 Identifying foliages and fillers	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
03 Conditioning fresh flowers	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
04 Cutting and stripping stems	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
05 Spiralling a hand-tied bouquet	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
06 Wrapping and presenting flowers	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
07 Working in floral foam	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
08 Front-facing arrangements	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
09 All-round arrangements	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
10 Buttonholes and corsages	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
11 Wiring techniques	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
12 Bridal bouquet construction	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
13 Funeral tributes and sheaves	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
14 Vessel selection and proportion	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
15 Colour theory in practice	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
16 Costing and pricing a piece	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Topic Checklists

A long view of the curriculum. Tick what's solid; circle what to revisit. Four themed lists across two pages.

Reference Knowledge NAMES · SCIENCE · SEASONS

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Botanical vs. common names | ☐ Flower anatomy: stem, calyx, corolla |
| ☐ Plant families relevant to florists | ☐ Ethylene sensitivity |
| ☐ The UK growing calendar | ☐ Imported vs. British-grown |
| ☐ Dutch auction and supply chain | ☐ Sustainability and Fair Trade marks |
| ☐ Cool-chain basics | ☐ Pests and common diseases |

Practical Skills HANDS-ON CRAFT

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Sharpening secateurs and snips | ☐ Conditioning a fresh delivery |
| ☐ Spiralling a 30-stem hand-tied | ☐ Working with floral foam |
| ☐ Pin-frog and chicken-wire mechanics | ☐ Wiring delicate florets |
| ☐ Building a buttonhole or corsage | ☐ Bridal bouquet construction |
| ☐ Funeral sheaf and tribute work | ☐ Photographing finished pieces |

Topic Checklists

Design Knowledge PRINCIPLES · STYLES · HISTORY

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Principles: balance, scale, rhythm | ☐ Focal vs. secondary, filler, foliage |
| ☐ Colour theory: hue, value, chroma | ☐ Texture and visual weight |
| ☐ Periodic styles: Georgian, Victorian | ☐ Dutch Masters and still-life |
| ☐ Ikebana and Eastern traditions | ☐ Contemporary & "wild" movement |
| ☐ Symbolism and the language of flowers | ☐ Composition by intention, not habit |

Professional Awareness BUSINESS · PEOPLE · CRAFT

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Costing materials & labour | ☐ Pricing and margin basics |
| ☐ Consultations and briefs | ☐ Wedding day logistics |
| ☐ Funeral protocol and sensitivity | ☐ Studio health & safety |
| ☐ Customer service and aftercare | ☐ Insurance and trade memberships |
| ☐ Social media and portfolio | ☐ Continuing professional development |

The Royal Horticultural Society

The RHS supports horticultural and floristry learning across the UK. Three of its qualifications are useful waypoints — use these cards to plan, then complete the short exercise below.

LEVEL 2

RHS Certificate

A grounding in horticulture: plant ID, growing, and the science behind a healthy stem. A natural first step for florists who want to understand their materials at the root.

≈ 1 year

Self-study

LEVEL 3

RHS Diploma

Builds on the Certificate with deeper plant science, propagation, and landscape practice. Industry-recognised across the trade and useful for those moving toward studio leadership.

≈ 2 years

Mixed delivery

LEVEL 4

RHS Master of Horticulture

Research-led postgraduate route for experienced horticulturists. Includes a dissertation. Most floristry students won't need it — but useful to know it's there.

≈ 3 years

Dissertation



RHS EXERCISE · A QUICK ORIENTATION

A QUALIFICATION I AM CONSIDERING

WHY IT MATTERS TO ME

ENTRY ROUTE I'LL TAKE

START DATE

THREE BOTANICAL TERMS I WANT TO LEARN

Further Resources

READ · STUDY · WATCH

A starter shelf. Add your own as you find them — the best ones often come by word of mouth at the bench.

BOOKS

The Flower Book

a seasonal field reference

On Form & Composition

principles for florists

British Cut Flowers

growers, seasons, sourcing

Colour for the Florist

theory and practice

The Wild Bunch

contemporary approach

QUALIFICATIONS

City & Guilds Floristry

Levels 2 / 3, vocational

RHS Certificate & Diploma

horticultural grounding

British Florist Association

trade body & events

Flowers from the Farm

British-grown network

Local college short courses

evening & weekend study

INDUSTRY & INSPIRATION

RHS Chelsea Flower Show

May, London

New Covent Garden Market

early-morning study trip

Flowerona & trade press

UK floristry news

Open studios near you

visits, workshops, mentors

Sustainable Floristry Network

foam-free practice

Glossary

A working dictionary. Add your own terms in the blanks — they'll be the ones you actually remember.

<i>Binding point</i>		<i>Mechanic</i>	
<i>Cool chain</i>		<i>Pin frog</i>	
<i>Conditioning</i>		<i>Posy</i>	
<i>Corsage</i>		<i>Recipe</i>	
<i>Filler</i>		<i>Scoring</i>	
<i>Focal</i>		<i>Sheaf</i>	
<i>Foliage</i>		<i>Sleeve</i>	
<i>Foam</i>		<i>Spiralling</i>	
<i>Hand-tied</i>		<i>Tribute</i>	
<i>Hardening off</i>		<i>Vase life</i>	
<i>Ikebana</i>		<i>Wiring</i>	
<i>Inflorescence</i>		<i>Woody stem</i>	
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Supplier Notes

WHO YOU BUY FROM, AND WHY

A few names you trust will quietly carry your career. Keep good notes.

SUPPLIER 01

NAME

SPECIALITY

CONTACT

MIN ORDER

NOTES

SUPPLIER 02

NAME

SPECIALITY

CONTACT

MIN ORDER

NOTES

SUPPLIER 03

NAME

SPECIALITY

CONTACT

MIN ORDER

NOTES

SUPPLIER 04

NAME

SPECIALITY

CONTACT

MIN ORDER

NOTES

SUPPLIER 05

NAME

SPECIALITY

CONTACT

MIN ORDER

NOTES

SUPPLIER 06

NAME

SPECIALITY

CONTACT

MIN ORDER

NOTES

Questions for Further Research

The questions you ask matter more than the answers you collect. Keep them here until you're ready to chase them.

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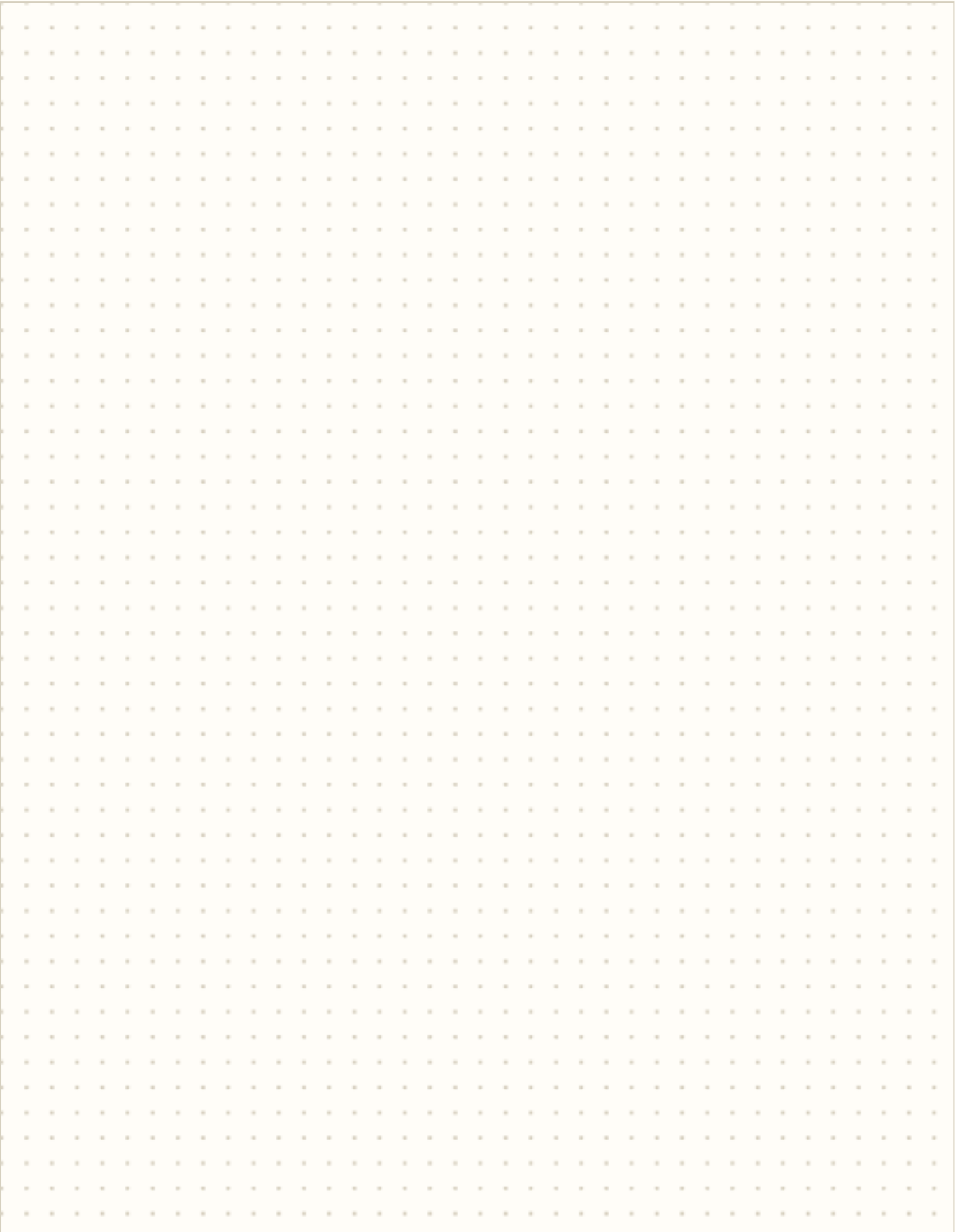
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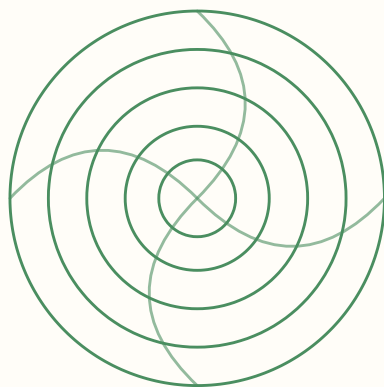
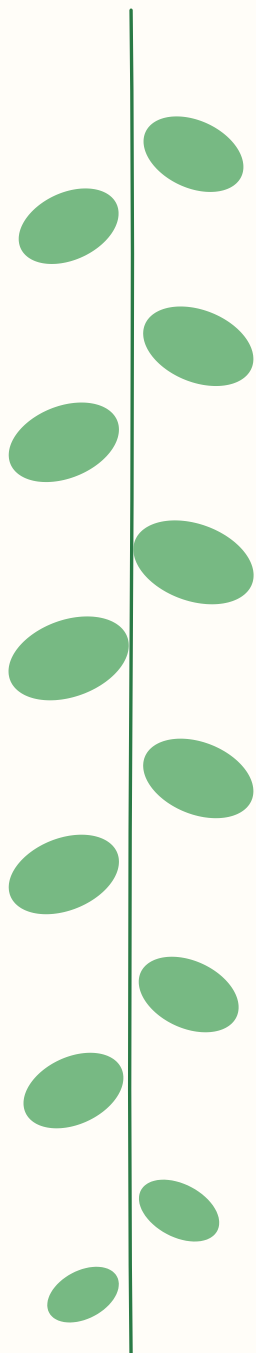
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Sketch & Notes





Learn. *Create.* Grow.

*A working journal is never finished —
only set down, for a while.*

My Floristry Helper

A STUDY COMPANION

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